C2 Speaking

Persuading and negotiating

Make a persuasive case, handle objections and reach agreement with precise, diplomatic language.

Persuasion at C2 is less about strong words than about framing: making your proposal sound reasonable, acknowledging the other side, and offering a way forward both sides can accept.

Move	Language
Framing the proposal	*What I'd like to propose is... The way I see it, this would allow us to...*
Appealing to shared goals	*We both want this to succeed, so... In everyone's interest,...*
Handling objections	*I take your point about cost. That said, if we look at the long term,...*
Conditional offers	*We could agree to that, provided that... If you were able to..., we'd be willing to...*
Closing	*So, are we in agreement that...? Shall we put that in writing?*

Soften with tentative forms. *Would it be possible to...?* and *I was wondering whether...* sound flexible, which makes the other side more willing to move.

Common mistake. Arguing against every objection. Conceding a small, true point (*You're right that it's more expensive*) makes your main argument more credible.

Practice

Write what you would say in a meeting about moving to a four-day week.

1. Introduce your proposal.
2. Respond to: "It will hurt customer service."

3. Make a conditional offer.
4. Appeal to a shared goal.
5. Close the discussion and confirm agreement.

Teacher page: answers

Print the pages before this one for students.

Answers

1. What I'd like to propose is a six-month trial of a four-day week for the design team.
2. I take your point about customer service. That said, we could stagger days off so the phones are always covered.
3. We'd be willing to start with one team, provided that we review the results together after three months.
4. We all want to keep good people, and this could make us a more attractive place to work.
5. So, are we agreed on a six-month trial with a review at three months? Shall we put that in writing?